

TOWNSHIP OF MOON

Municipal Center

1000 Beaver Grade Road • Moon Township, PA 15108-2984

Telephone: 412-262-1700 • Fax: 412-262-5344 • moontwp@moontwp.com

April 2, 2013

Mr. Ray McCutcheon, Manager
Borough of Coraopolis
1012 5th Avenue
Coraopolis, PA 15108

Re: Ohio River Trail – Phase I

Dear Mr. McCutcheon,

On behalf of Moon Township, we would like to express our support for the 2013 Coraopolis application to the Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) for a \$200,000 Community Conservation Partnerships Program Grant. In 2012, the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) successfully submitted an application on behalf of Coraopolis, which was awarded a \$200,000 Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program (TCSP) Grant from the Federal Highway Administration for the development of the Ohio River Trail – Phase I (ORT-PH1). The ORTC is respectfully requesting your support of the ORT-PH1 project. The \$400,000 in funding will employ a consultant to prepare engineering specifications and bid documents and to begin the construction of 2.5-miles of the Ohio River Trail (ORT) through Coraopolis, Moon Township and to Sewickley via the Sewickley Bridge.

The ORT-PH1 is part of the ORTC's overall plan to develop a forty-one mile multi-use land & water trail system along the Ohio River and its tributaries, known as the Ohio River Trail. The corridor runs from Coraopolis, PA to Ohioville, PA near the three-way intersection of OH, PA and WV where the ORT will link to Cleveland and the Great Lakes region via the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway. The ORT-PH1 project is an exciting transportation prospect that it connects two wonderful recreational projects in Allegheny County, the seventy-eight acre Allegheny County Sports & Athletic Complex and the Moon Township Waterfront Park. These two sites are former industrial sites, and are brownfields under redevelopment. In fact, with the support of an ORTC community revitalization initiative, the U.S. EPA funded Partnership for Sustainable Communities Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project addressed the reclamation and reuse of certain brownfields along the Ohio River including Coraopolis, PA.

In 2009, the ORTC, in partnership with eight communities along the south shore, received a PA-DCNR Planning Grant to prepare a feasibility study to bond the municipalities together via a multi-modal trail and to improve public access to the Ohio River. The Ohio River South Shore Trail (ORSST) Feasibility Study is complete and has identified a series of proposed recommendations to create a greenway along the Ohio River corridor, which links the current

TOWNSHIP OF MOON

Mr. Ray McCutcheon

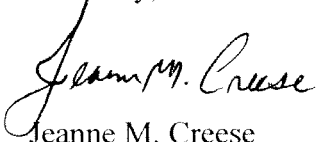
Page Two

April 2, 2013

46-mile Montour Trail and the Great Allegheny Passage to Beaver County, PA. The Study is available for download at <http://www.ohiorivertrail.org/index.php/ohio-river-trail-south-shore/orsst-feasibility-study>.

From this study, comes the ORT-PH1 request for funding. The ORTC and partners are eager to begin the implementation of the ORSST Feasibility Study and are encouraged about this opportunity to show on-the-ground success of this regional project.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Jeanne M. Creese". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Jeanne" being more prominent.

Jeanne M. Creese
Township Manager